



School and Childcare Cleaning: Building a Safer Routine

A practical, age-aware routine for classrooms,
shared spaces, restrooms and daily facility
response.

August facility series 07 of 10

Review draft for Corinne and Russ. Not published on ami-cleaning.com yet.

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A school cleaning routine should prioritize high-touch areas, restrooms, shared spaces, safe product use and clear responsibility.

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An effective school or childcare cleaning routine assigns tasks by room and time of day, prioritizes visibly dirty and frequently used surfaces, protects children from chemicals and equipment, and includes a documented inspection process. The plan should fit the age group, schedule and facility policy.

Map spaces around how children use them

Classrooms, restrooms, changing areas, food spaces, nap rooms, gyms, entrances and staff offices have different needs. Identify toys or learning materials that classroom staff maintain, surfaces handled by custodial staff and items that require manufacturer-specific care.

AMI's [school and daycare cleaning service](#) can be scoped around operating hours, secure access and age-appropriate routines.

Build a daily rhythm

During occupied hours: respond to spills, monitor restrooms, restock supplies and address visible soil without creating trip hazards or exposing children to cleaning products.

After children leave: complete the broader classroom, restroom, floor, waste and shared-space scope with better access and protected drying time.

Periodic work: schedule high dusting, floor restoration, detailed edges and other work that needs extra equipment or room downtime.

The [CDC's general facility guidance](#) emphasizes regular cleaning, cleaning before disinfecting when surfaces are visibly dirty, and following product label directions. Facility health policies and applicable licensing requirements may be more specific and should control.

Keep products and tools controlled

Store chemicals, dilution systems and equipment away from children. Never leave an unattended cart in an accessible classroom or corridor. Use the required personal protective equipment, ventilation and contact time, and ensure surfaces are ready before the room reopens.

Facilities considering products evaluated for human-health and environmental criteria can consult [EPA Safer Choice](#). Product suitability and label directions still matter for each task.

Verify with short, specific inspections

Check restrooms and supplies during the day, then audit a rotating set of classrooms after service. Record specific findings and trends. If art projects, weather or events change the soil load, adjust the plan rather than treating the original frequency as permanent.

[Ask AMI for a facility walkthrough](#) in Delaware, Eastern Maryland or Southeastern Pennsylvania.

Frequently asked questions

How often should classrooms be cleaned?

Occupied classrooms commonly need daily cleaning, with response during the day for spills and visible soil. Exact tasks and frequencies should follow use, age group and facility policy.

Should every classroom surface be disinfected every day?

Not automatically. Use the school's approved plan, product label and public-health guidance. Routine cleaning and targeted disinfection should be distinguished.

Who is responsible for cleaning toys and learning materials?

Assign responsibility in writing. Teachers may manage some materials while custodial staff manage environmental surfaces; manufacturer directions and facility policy apply.



Walk the building. Then write the plan.

AMI scopes rooms, traffic, access, surfaces and standards before shift one across Delaware, Eastern Maryland and Southeastern Pennsylvania.

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Exact live logo

Locked artwork from ami-cleaning.com. Spelling, geometry and colors are unchanged.

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